SIMPLE PROGRAMME · UNFPA BANGLADESH · BANDHU

KoboToolbox Manual for Managers

Bandhu Social Welfare Society · for Wellness Centre managers and the Bandhu M&E focal · viewing, checking, editing, validating, deleting and downloading data · Version 1.0 · August 2026

This manual covers the KoboToolbox website, where your organisation reads and corrects the data your field teams collect. It is written for managers. Field workers need only the mobile app, which is covered in the field guide.

1 Kobo and the dashboard are two different tools

KoboToolbox (kf.kobotoolbox.org)	SIMPLE dashboard (simpledashboard.pro)
Holds the raw submissions exactly as the field sent them. Here you view records, correct mistakes, mark a validation status, delete a genuinely invalid record, and download data as Excel.	Holds the approved programme figures. Here you approve records, watch indicators and maps, and generate the monthly report kit.

✓ A number on the dashboard moves when you **approve** a record there. The validation status inside Kobo is an internal marker for your own team and changes no indicator. If you have time for one habit only, make it clearing the dashboard approval queue.

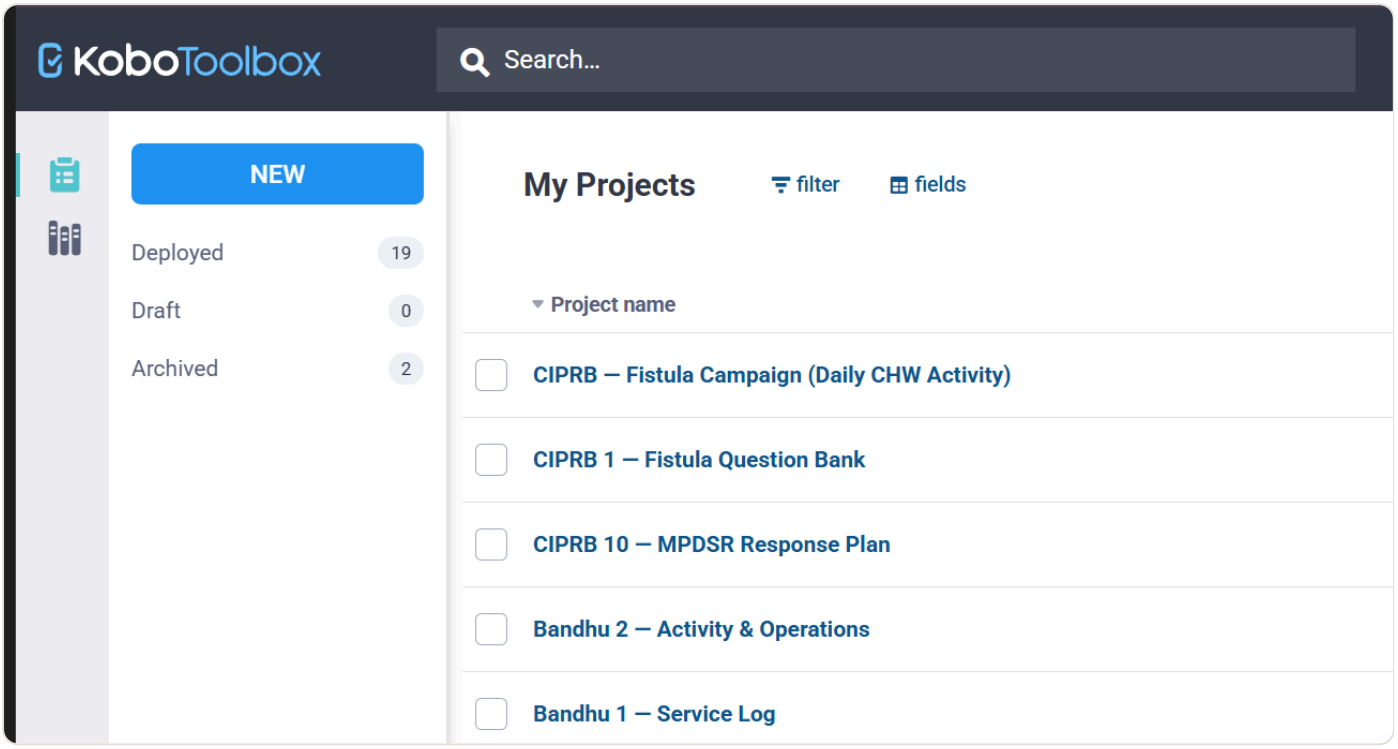
2 Signing in and finding your forms

a Open the site

Go to **kf.kobotoolbox.org** and sign in with the account your organisation was given. Do not share the password: every action is recorded against the account that performed it.

b Open a project

The project list shows every form with its submission count on the right. Click a form name to open it.

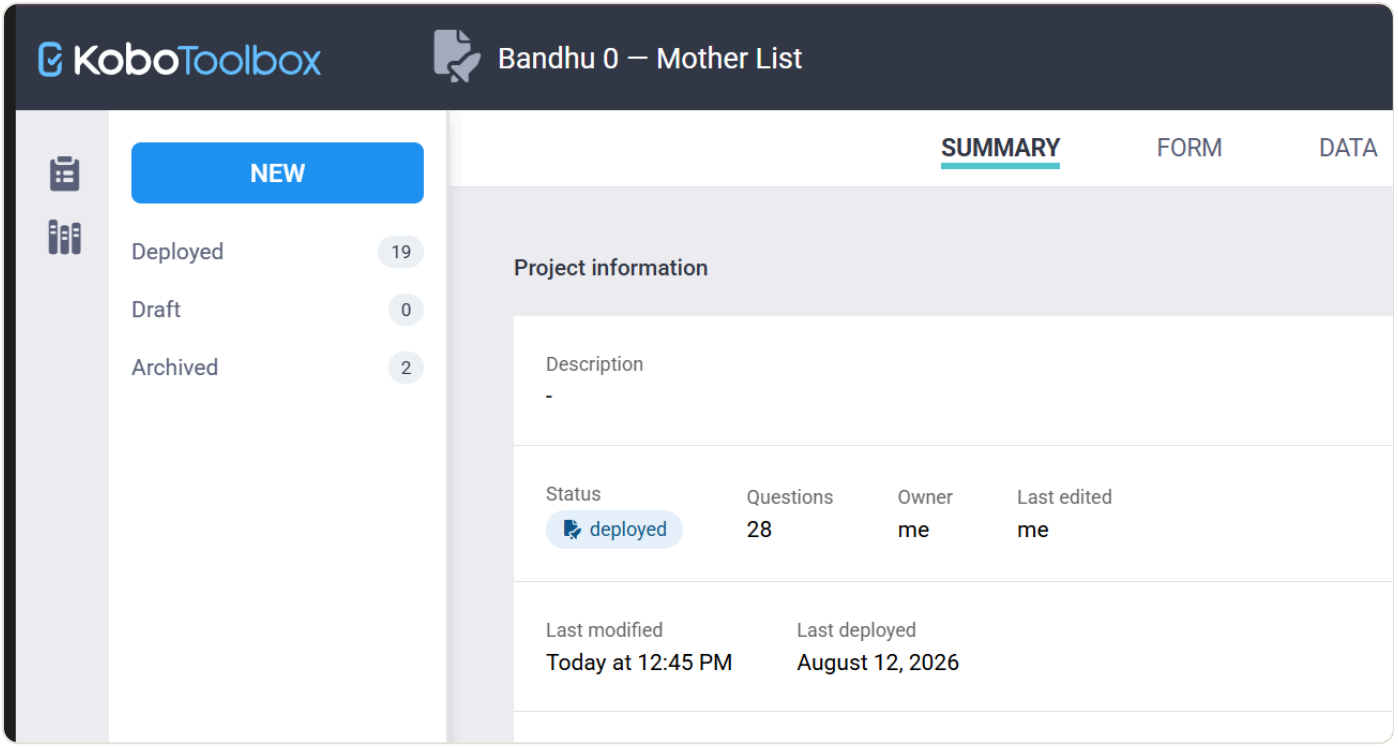


The project list. Each row is one form; the number is its total submissions.

Your forms in KoboToolbox	Submissions to date
Bandhu 0 - Mother List	2,546
Bandhu 1 - Service Log	1,514
Bandhu 2 - Activity & Operations	4,544

3 The four tabs of a form

Tab	What it is for
SUMMARY	Overview of the form, with quick links to the data table and downloads.
FORM	The questionnaire structure. **Read only for you.** Changing a form here can break the app on every field phone.
DATA	Everything in this manual: the table, single records, validation, editing, deleting and downloads.
SETTINGS	Project settings and the connection that feeds the dashboard. **Never change anything here.**



The SUMMARY page of a form, with Quick Links on the right.

Working with data

4 Reading the data table

a Open it

Click the DATA tab. Table is the first item in the left menu.

b Learn the three controls

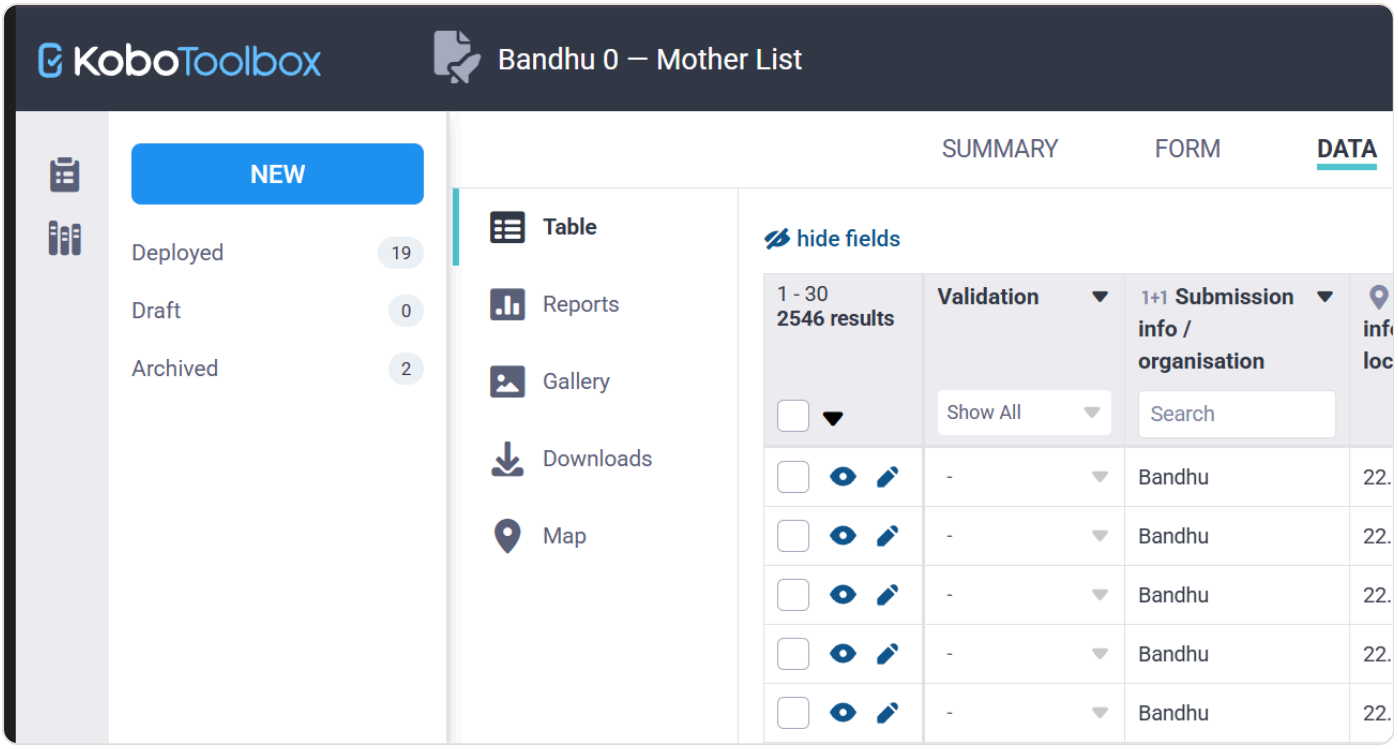
At the start of each row: the **eye** opens the full record, the **pencil** opens it for correction, and the **checkbox** selects it for a bulk action.

c Search and sort

Every column has a search box under its title. Use it to find an ID, a name or a date. Click a column title to sort by it.

d Move between pages

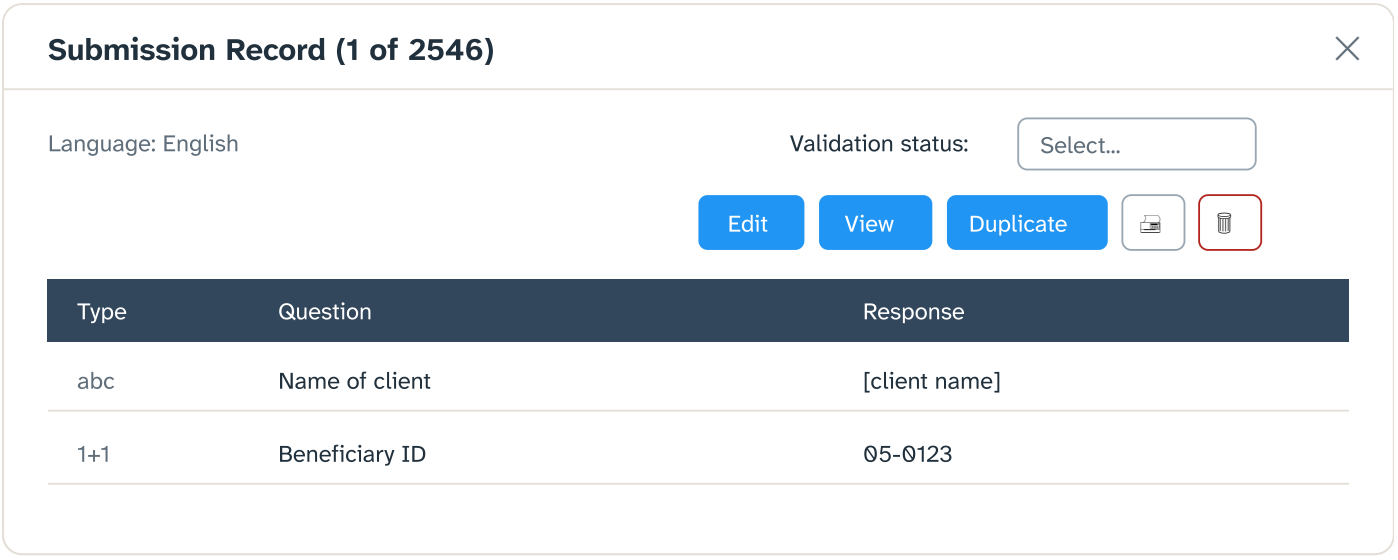
PREV and NEXT under the table show the next set of records, and the selector beside them raises the rows shown per page.



The data table. Checkbox, eye and pencil on the left, Validation column next.

5 Viewing one record

Clicking the eye opens the record with every question and answer in order.



Edit opens the record for correction. **View** shows it read only. **Duplicate** makes a copy and should never be used, because it creates a second record for the same event. The printer icon prints the record and the red bin deletes it. Previous and Next move through records without returning to the table.

6 Setting a validation status

Use the status to tell your own team what you have already checked.

Validation status: Select...

- Not approved
- Approved
- On hold

Set the status after you have checked the record. The same three options appear in the Validation column of the data table.

Status	Use it when
Approved	You checked the record against the field register and it is correct.
Not approved	Something is wrong and the field team must correct or resubmit it.
On hold	You cannot decide yet and want to return to it.

✓ This is not the programme approval. Programme approval happens on the dashboard and is what moves the indicators.

7 Correcting a record

a Open for editing

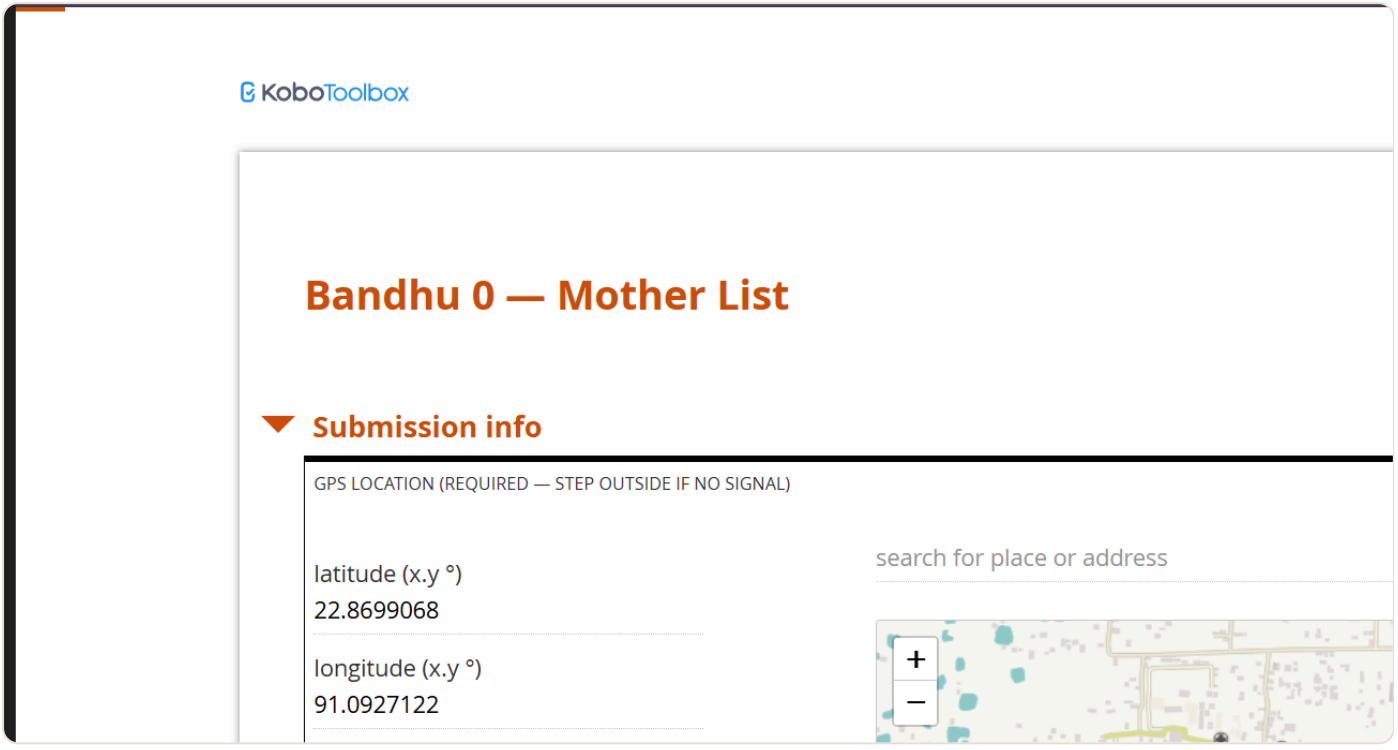
Click the pencil in the table, or Edit inside an open record. The form opens in a new tab with the previous answers filled in.

b Change only what is wrong

Leave every other answer untouched, and never change an ID field.

c Press Submit at the very bottom

Scroll to the end and press the orange **Submit** button. Nothing is saved until you do; closing the tab discards the change.

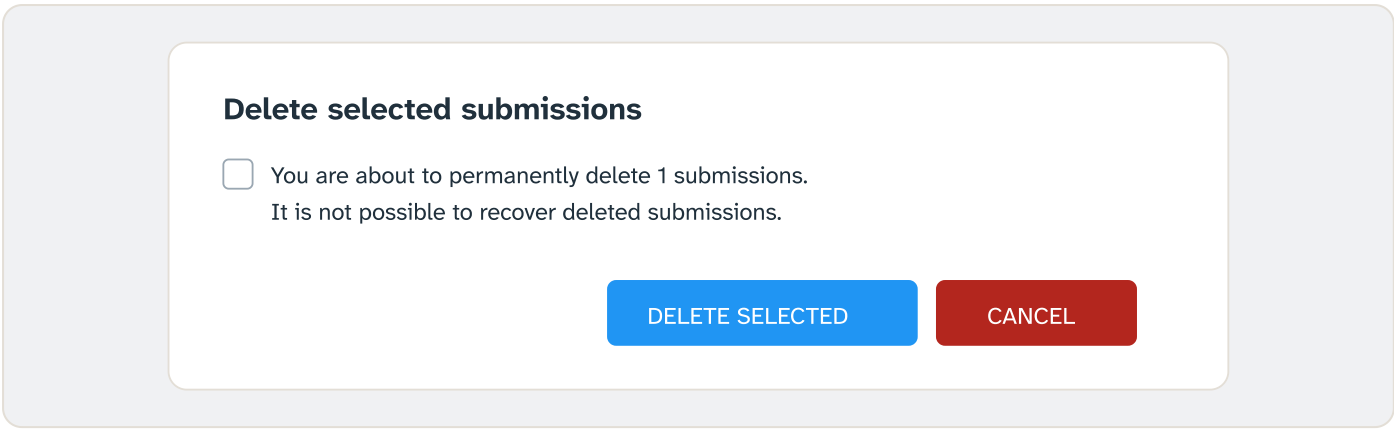


The edit screen opens in a new tab. Submit sits at the very bottom of it.

! A correction replaces the answer but keeps the record and its history. Always prefer correcting over deleting.

8 Deleting a record

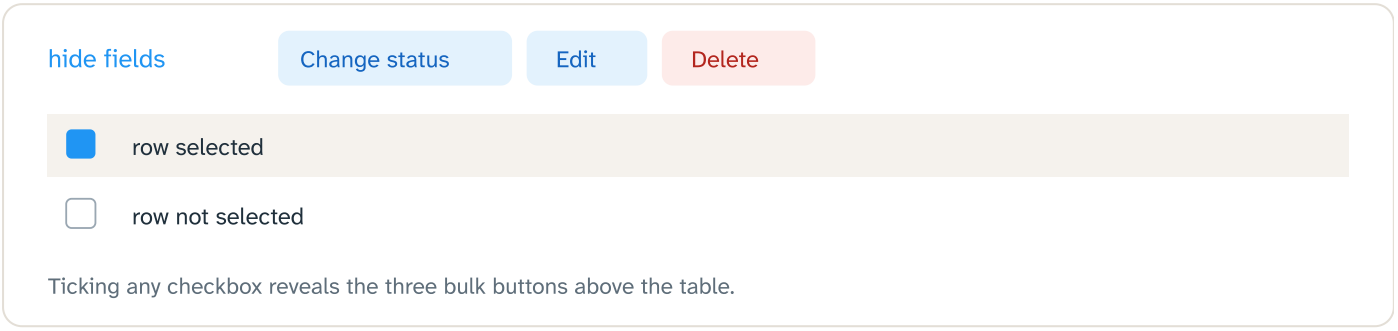
The red bin inside a record, or the Delete button above the table, opens this confirmation.



! **Deletion is permanent. KoboToolbox has no recycle bin.** Before deleting anything: (1) be certain the record is genuinely invalid, not merely confusing; (2) if in doubt, mark it Not approved instead; (3) download the XLS export first as a backup; (4) email the list of what you deleted and why to the CIPRB M&E team, so the dashboard figures can be reconciled.

✓ Duplicates, test entries and records belonging to another centre are the usual valid reasons to delete. A wrong date or a misspelled name is not: correct those instead.

9 Working on many records at once



Ticking any checkbox reveals the three bulk buttons above the table.

a **Select**

Tick the checkbox on each row, or the checkbox in the header to take the whole page.

b **Change status**

Applies one validation status to everything selected.

c **Delete**

Deletes everything selected at once. Every caution in section 8 applies twice over here.

10 Downloading data to Excel

a **Open Downloads**

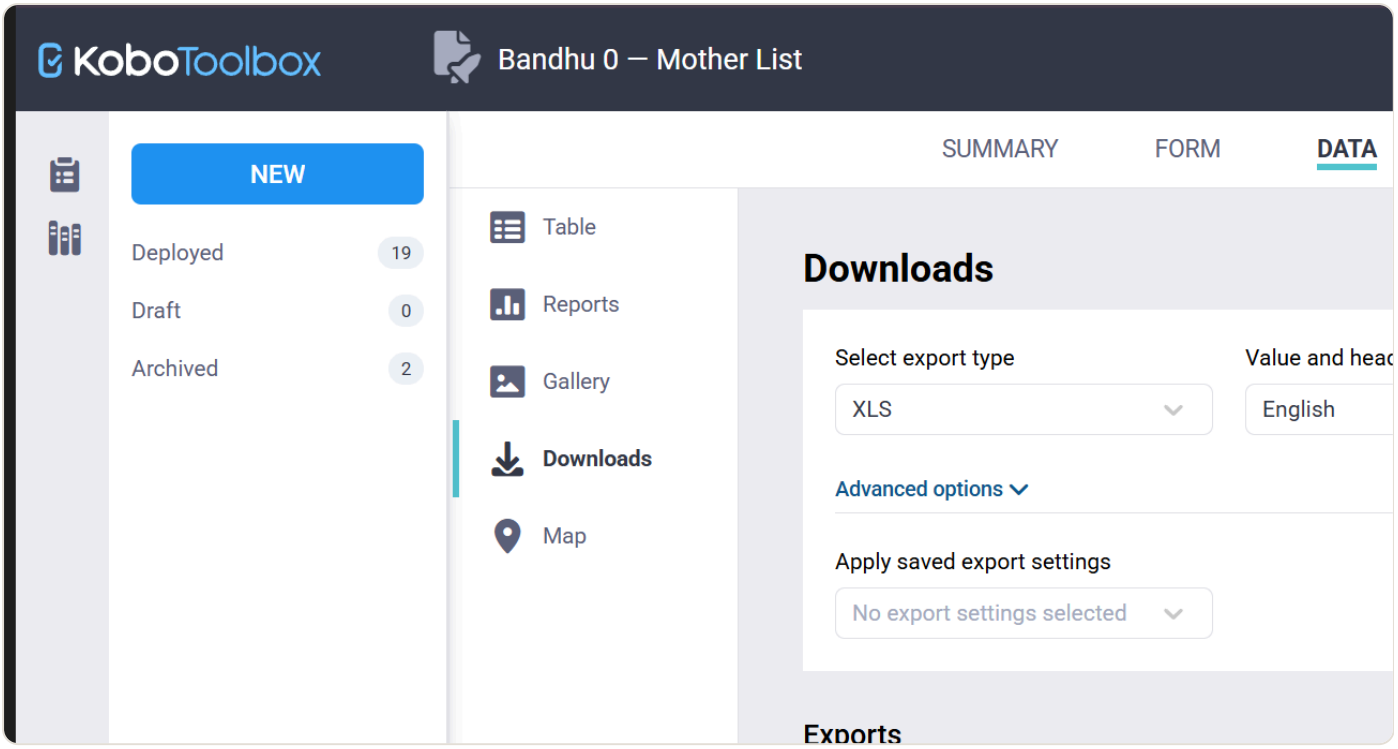
In the DATA tab, click Downloads in the left menu.

b **Choose the format**

Export type **XLS**, value and header format **English**.

c **Export and save**

Press Export, wait for the file to appear, then download it.



The Downloads page. XLS plus English is the standard choice.

✓ This export is your backup before any bulk change, and the file your office should keep every month.

How Bandhu data works

11 Approval model

Bandhu records pass **two approval gates**: first the Bandhu manager approves on the dashboard, then UNFPA gives the final approval. A record counts towards an indicator only after BOTH gates. Mother List registrations are the exception: they are approved automatically so the client appears in the service-form lookup lists immediately.

12 How IDs are created

Beneficiary IDs are **issued by the server**, never typed. The field worker fills in the client details and the system assigns the next free number for that centre (for example 05-0427) within moments, then writes it back into the Kobo record. Never edit an ID field.

13 Points to watch in Bandhu

Point	Why it matters
Do not delete a record because an ID looks wrong	Almost every such case is a lookup list that had not refreshed on the phone. Check the Mother List first and ask the field team to run Get Blank Form.
Watch the F-01 logbook ticks	Four indicators (GBV, mental health, STI services, HIV testing) are counted only from the service ticks on the F-01 Wellness Centre Service Logbook. If your team fills the detailed registers but leaves those ticks empty, the work appears in no report.
Two-stage approval means your queue is not the last step	After you approve, the record waits for UNFPA. If figures still look low, check whether records are waiting at the second gate.

14 Your routine

When	What to do
Daily	Open the dashboard approval queue and clear the new records.
Weekly	Skim the Kobo data table of each of your three forms for obvious errors: blank names, wrong dates, the same client twice.
Monthly	Download all three forms as XLS and keep them on the office drive.
Monthly	Share the new client ID list with the field team so their paper registers match the system.

15 Quick troubleshooting

Situation	What to do
The dashboard shows fewer numbers than the field reports	Open the dashboard approval queue. Unapproved records never count, and this explains most such reports.
A field worker cannot find a client in a form dropdown	Ask them to run Get Blank Form in KoboCollect, which refreshes the client list. They must never register the person again.
A submission shows as Sent on the phone but is not in Kobo	Wait a few hours, because delivery retries by itself. If it never arrives, ask the worker to open it in the Sent list and send again.
A record is in Kobo but not on the dashboard	One delivery to the dashboard failed. Report it to the CIPRB M&E team, who can have it replayed.
Two records look like the same person	Verify with the field which one is real, back up, remove the duplicate, and email the details to CIPRB M&E.
A question or answer option is missing from a form	Form changes are made only by the system maintainer. Send the request to the CIPRB M&E team.

16 Do and never do

Do

- Clear the dashboard approval queue at least twice a week
- Correct mistakes by editing, and finish with Submit
- Download an XLS backup before any bulk action
- Report deletions and duplicates to CIPRB M&E
- Keep one account per person

Never

- Change anything in the FORM or SETTINGS tab
- Use the Duplicate button
- Edit an ID field
- Delete without a backup and a certainty
- Share a password or work in another person account

17 Who to ask

Question	Ask
How to fill a form in the field	The field supervisor, using the field guide
Anything in this manual	Your own M&E focal
System problems, replays, form changes, deletions to reconcile	CIPRB M&E team